

BREATHLINE · STRATEGIC POSITIONING · JULY 2026

The Uncapturable Constellation

Strategic positioning of the Universal Sovereign Node

A distributed constellation of lower-powered, low-latency nodes does not need to match frontier intelligence node-for-node. It competes on a different axis — **resilience, custody, attestation, uncapturability** — and it wins where those decide the outcome.

Distributed sovereignty, built on open models and against capture: what runs today, what is designed, and where the human seal sits. Every capability on every slide carries its grade.

SHIPS TODAY: THE RECEIPTED KERNEL

FEDERATION AT SCALE: DESIGNED · BUILDING

MONEY_PATH OFF

Nothing here is an offer. All economics are modeled, not measured. Nothing claims more than its receipts.

Capability is rented. Architecture is owned.

THE HONEST LINE

The capability gap is real, and this deck states it before it argues with it. What follows is a narrower claim than parity — and a more durable one.

- 1 • Frontier models win peak reasoning. That is not in dispute here, and no slide in this deck disputes it.
- 2 • Peak reasoning does not decide privacy-critical, offline, regulated, or generational work. **Custody, continuity and provable record do** — and those are architectural properties, not model properties.
- 3 • A single low-powered node is weak. A constellation of attested nodes is not: it has no center to compel, no single root of availability, and a per-node blast radius.
- 4 • The differentiator has moved from the weights to the harness — deterministic gates that bind to no model, and one gate that never automates.

The one-sentence proof point — a 31B open-weight model on a single consumer GPU, driven by deterministic gates and a human seal, produced prose that **blind judges scored at or above our own published catalog on all six dimensions**. Bounded body production, not a finished book — slide 4 carries the caveats in full. Capability was not the moat. The harness was.

Three lanes, 2026 — one of them is a collaborator

Closed frontier

API-GATED · JURISDICTION-BOUND

- ✗ Highest peak capability, reached only through someone else's endpoint
- ✗ Terms, price and rate limits reset on the vendor's clock, not yours
- ✗ One jurisdiction's order reaches every user of that endpoint at once
- ✗ Model deprecation retires the capability you built on
- ✗ Usage telemetry is inherent to the delivery model

Open models — the collaborative substrate

THE ENGINES A NODE RUNS · CAPTURE LIVES IN THE SURROUNDINGS

- ◇ **These are the engines the constellation runs on:** Llama 4 Maverick / Scout, DeepSeek V3 / R1, Qwen3, Mistral Large 3 — near-frontier, downloadable, runnable on a node
- ◇ **The risk is not the models or the people who make them** — it is what has grown up around them
- ◇ Serving is concentrated in a handful of hosts
- ◇ Distribution runs through a small number of hubs and registries
- ◇ Licenses are revised at the next release; funding is concentrated
- ◇ Tooling around the weights often phones home even when the weights do not

Edge & attested constellation

WEAK ALONE · STRONG ATTESTED

- ✓ Lower peak capability per node — stated plainly, not argued away
- ✓ Weights, records and keys sit inside the operator's walls
- ✓ Every consequential act is receipted, hash-chained and replayable
- ✓ No central root of availability; no single party to compel
- ✓ Value accrues from attestation and continuity, not from peak scores

Model families above are named as **public-landscape context** — they are not benchmarks we ran, comparison targets we tested, or claims about our own stack. **The open-model lane is a collaborator, not a competitor:** the constellation is built to run on those weights, and the middle and right columns are the same argument seen from two ends. *We hold receipts for the third column only; columns one and two are read from the open record.*

Peak intelligence vs practical resilience

THE HONEST LINE

A node-class model is not a frontier model, and we do not claim it is. The claim is narrower: a deterministic harness closes the output-quality gap on bounded work — body production, proven. Book assembly is the unbuilt tail.

WHERE THE FRONTIER WINS — AND WE SAY SO

- ▶ Peak multi-step reasoning on novel, unbounded problems
- ▶ Very long context held coherently in one pass
- ▶ Breadth across modalities and languages
- ▶ Rate of improvement per calendar quarter
- ▶ Ecosystem velocity — tools, integrations, hiring pool

Our own tier configuration routes the hardest adversarial and structural passes to a frontier tier. We do not pretend otherwise. The floor law in the same file: **gates never relax by model class — deterministic stages bind to no model.**

WHAT THE HARNESS CLOSED — BLIND BOARD, 15 EXCERPTS vs 12 PUBLISHED CONTROLS

DIMENSION	Δ VS PUBLISHED	PRIOR PILOT Δ	VERDICT
Voice	0.0	1.0	PASS
Pacing	0.0	1.0	PASS
Concreteness	-0.5 — beats published	1.0	PASS
Payoff	0.0	2.0	PASS
Coherence	-0.5 — beats published	0.0	PASS
Verifiability	-1.0 — beats published	2.0	PASS

Lower is better (distance from the published control). Three fresh blind judges, a discrimination judge and a cross-chapter template audit; judges did not know which excerpts were machine-drafted.

Carried caveats: the discrimination result is contaminated by a formatting artifact and will be re-run; one chapter failed; one load-bearing fact contradiction survived to the board; volume came in at 8,194 words, under the floor.

The Universal Sovereign Node, as built

THE HONEST LINE

Seven of the eight run on the trunk today, each with a named passing test file. The eighth — the policy-and-token layer — is built and tested on a build branch and is not on the trunk; we count it separately for exactly that reason.

Append-only receipted ledger + replay

RUNS TODAY

Propose → approve → execute, hash-chained. Replaying the chain reproduces the state exactly.

Human primacy gate, fail-closed

RUNS TODAY

A material act on a gateless ledger is **refused outright** — and the denial is written into the record. The proposer cannot approve their own act.

Incremental Merkle attestation

RUNS TODAY

Appending recomputes only the right frontier — $O(\log n)$, not a rebuild — and the root is byte-identical to the reference tree at every leaf count.

Quorum · mandate · witness guards

RUNS TODAY

The same reviewer twice is not a quorum; one human in several fiduciary roles cannot approve across them by accident; a malformed config fails closed.

Deterministic self-verifying export packet

RUNS TODAY

Manifest, entries, receipts, proof, chain range, digest — one bundle an auditor validates on a clean machine. Same inputs, byte-identical bundle.

Policy-at-the-write + token-typed schema

BUILT · STAGED

Refusal happens **at the write**, with the rule id cited in the record itself. 20 acceptance tests green — on the build branch, **not yet folded to the trunk**. A token here is a private, ledgered entry derived from signed receipts; money_path stays off.

One-command bootstrap

RUNS TODAY

Install, activate, connect. Bundled demo roles produce real attested output with no external clone, no account, no telemetry, no custody.

Local-first production line, default-deny gates

RUNS TODAY

Manifest-driven builds through declared gates under receipts, byte-parity reprints, offline rebuild from the bundle — and exactly one gate that never automates: the human seal.

The number, stated properly — 442 tests green on main (+20 staged): the twenty-test policy-and-token layer is green on the build branch and pending fold. 54 test files on the trunk, 59 with the staged layer. Suite runs in about sixteen seconds, zero failures, zero skips.

One node is weak. The constellation is the argument.

THE HONEST LINE

Two-node witness transport is built and tested. Production receipted-shard propagation is designed and deferred — and there is no diagram in this deck showing a mesh, because we do not simulate one.

CROSS-NODE WITNESS

RUNS TODAY

Two nodes exchange receipts so **both hold a signed copy**. A tampered remote entry is refused. An unwitnessed entry is refused. An imported approval **never gets privileged standing** on your chain — evidence can arrive from outside; authority cannot.

Nine tests, named. Your record stays the record.

FEDERATION TOPOLOGY

DESIGNED · BUILDING

Production receipted-shard propagation across many nodes is **specified and deferred** to the federation substrate. The node's local surface reserves the routes; the standing instruction on the work is explicit and we quote it: **do not fake a mesh**.

Designed · building. Not deployed, not simulated, not shown.

NODES CHECKING NODES

RUNS TODAY

The working example is our own production line: a build engine, an adversary pass, and a blind review board — separate agents grading each other's output under deterministic gates, with the seal reserved for a named human. **Multi-agent checking is not a projection here; it produced the evidence on the previous slide.**

Orchestration in production on our own catalog.

The scaling argument — a constellation does not add intelligence by adding nodes; it adds **independent attestation surface**. Ten nodes that each hold a signed copy of an exchange do not make a smarter model — they make a record that no single party can revise, lose, or be compelled to produce alone.

“Sovereign” means these thirteen tests, passed

THE HONEST LINE

Sovereignty is not a marketing word here — it is this checklist: your keys, your records, your exit. Eight are designed to be machine-checked on every contribution; five are human audits. Board-reviewable, not sealed.

- 1

YOUR KEYS STAY YOURS — never held by a vendor, never rebuildable from outside your walls

MACHINE-CHECKED
- 2

NO BORROWED IDENTITY — nothing depends on an account, certificate, or ID that a provider controls

MACHINE-CHECKED
- 3

OPEN FORMATS, PROVABLE AT HOME — any independent reader opens every format; proof still works if the provider vanishes

MACHINE-CHECKED
- 4

◆ RECEIPTS BOTH SIDES — every exchange leaves a signed copy with both parties

MACHINE-CHECKED
- 5

◆ YOUR RECORD IS THE RECORD — outside ledgers can add evidence — they never overrule the receipts in your house

MACHINE-CHECKED
- 6

EVERY PART REPLACEABLE — hardware, storage, and adapters swap out without losing who you are or what happened

MACHINE-CHECKED
- 7

◆ CLEAN EXIT, NO KILL SWITCH — remove it all and your records still work; your heirs continue; no remote switch can shut you off or void old proofs

MACHINE-CHECKED
- 8

FORGETFUL BY DESIGN — nothing private we couldn't rebuild from public receipts — “no memory that lets 2026 tax 2040”

MACHINE-CHECKED
- 9

YOUR FILES DON'T LEAVE — originals stay inside your walls by default; sharing is optional, minimal, approved by you

AUDITED
- 10

NOTHING PHONES HOME — no reporting outward without your consent; monitoring can run entirely at home

AUDITED
- 11

◆ THE HUMAN YES — no gate fires without a named person saying yes

AUDITED
- 12

◆ PROOFS SAY WHAT THEY PROVE — marks, signatures, and records claim only what they actually establish

AUDITED
- 13

NO RENT ON YOUR OWN HISTORY — no contract or patent can strand your records, block continued use, or invent a future toll

AUDITED

◆ **Five are already demonstrated at node level by named kernel tests** — a node-level demonstration, **not the network-wide gate**; the eight are a design for continuous checking, not a job running today. Pass all thirteen and **“sovereign” is earned, not claimed** — they protect users from everyone, **including us**.

The positioning matrix

THE HONEST LINE

Two rows say lose, and they are the first two rows on the page, because a matrix with eight wins is a marketing document, not an analysis. The comparison target is centralized deployment — closed endpoints and centrally served open models alike — never the open-model community itself.

AXIS	VERDICT	WHY	WHERE IT IS ANCHORED
Raw reasoning ceiling	LOSE	The frontier holds it. A node-class model does bounded work well; it does not lead a benchmark.	Route the hardest pass to a declared tier where the operator permits it — the gates stay deterministic either way.
Ecosystem velocity	LOSE TIE / DESIGNED	Lose today — the frontier ecosystem ships faster and hires easier. Designed toward parity via federation, not claimed.	Federation at production scale is designed and deferred; today this column is honestly behind.
Privacy & data custody	WIN	Originals stay inside the walls; there is no third-party custodian to compel, breach or subpoena.	Tests 9 & 10 — your files don't leave, nothing phones home.
Offline / contested availability	WIN	The node runs with the network down. Bundled roles produce attested output with no external call.	One-command bootstrap; offline rebuild from the bundle inside the volume's own tree.
Attestation & auditability	WIN	Hash-chained record, incremental Merkle root, self-verifying export packet an auditor validates cold.	Audit-by-replay, not audit-by-assertion.
Regulatory compellability	WIN	There is no central operator to serve. Compulsion has to reach each owner, in each owner's jurisdiction.	Structural, not magical — see the risk slide.
Cost per sovereign seat	WIN	No API key, no inference bill, no seat licence. The marginal cost of a run is the operator's own electricity.	Hardware is capex the operator already owns or chooses.
Long-horizon continuity	WIN	The record outlives the vendor, the model, and the operator. Heirs continue; no remote switch voids old proofs.	Test 7 — clean exit, no kill switch. Test 13 — no rent on your own history.

Defense against closed-frontier dependence

THE HONEST LINE

None of this makes the node smarter than the endpoint. It makes the node’s continuity independent of the endpoint’s owner — a different property, and the only one that survives a legal order.

THEIR LEVER	WHAT IT DOES TO YOU	THE NODE’S COUNTER	TEST #
Terms-of-service revision	Your workflow is re-permissioned overnight; continued use is deemed agreement.	Local weights, local ledger authoritative. Nothing re-permissions on someone else’s clock.	2 · 13
Price and rate-limit changes	Unit economics reset without your say; the cheapest tier is withdrawn.	The marginal cost of a run is your own electricity. There is no meter to re-price.	13
Jurisdictional order	Your data is produced by a party that is not you, in a venue you did not choose.	Originals never leave by default; there is no third-party custodian holding them to compel.	9 · 10
Model deprecation	The capability you built on is retired on the vendor’s schedule.	Every part replaceable — weights, storage, adapters swap without losing who you are or what happened.	6
Telemetry & usage capture	Your usage patterns become someone else’s asset.	Nothing phones home; monitoring runs entirely at home. No account, no external clone in the bundled path.	10
Account termination	History, proofs and audience vanish with the login.	Clean exit, no kill switch: remove it all and the records still work; heirs continue.	7
Implementation lock-in	There is one implementation and it is not yours.	The invariants are license-conditioned; forking is the intended remedy if the project fails its own principles.	1 · 3

Not a claim of invulnerability. A fork that keeps the source but strips the four kernel invariants at runtime is **unlicensed** — legal and structural, not magical. What the architecture removes is the *single point of compulsion*, not the possibility of adversity.

Completing the open-model commons

THE HONEST LINE

Open weights are the gift this argument is built on — the threat named here is capture of the commons, never the commons itself. And we do not have mirrors today: uncapturable distribution is designed and activation-gated, waiting on the production line and an explicit human word. Claiming otherwise would be the exact failure this deck argues against.

Where capture reaches the commons

- ✗ **Serving concentration** — the weights are free; the inference that most people actually use is not, and it runs in a few places
- ✗ **License revision** — terms can tighten at the next release; what shipped free does not guarantee what ships next
- ✗ **Distribution chokepoints** — a small number of hubs, registries and CDNs stand between the weights and the operator
- ✗ **Telemetry-laden tooling** — the harness around the model reports even when the model does not
- ✗ **Funding concentration** — the open lane depends on a few sponsors continuing to fund it

What the node adds to the commons

- ✓ **A verified local copy is sufficient** — a copy you already hold, with a checked digest, does not un-download when terms change
- ✓ **Content-addressed release + a mirror substrate** — **designed; activation gated** behind the production line and an explicit human word. Parked and inert until then
- ✓ **The kernel ships its own way out** — every source file, digest, manifest entry and pinned environment record lives inside the volume's own tree; a clone is a recovery medium
- ✓ **License-conditioned invariants** — human primacy, default-deny, audit-immutable, validated extension. Strip them at runtime and the fork is unlicensed
- ✓ **Forking is the intended remedy** — capture, enclosure and sovereignty-stripping are what the licence bars; copying is not

The asymmetry, restated: open weights solve *possession*. They do not solve *continuity* — who serves them, under what terms, discoverable how, and provable by whom afterwards. **That gap is where the node lives — as the completion layer for the open-model commons, not as its rival.**

Attack surface: cluster vs constellation

THE HONEST LINE

The middle column is architecture, not deployment — two-node witness transport is built and tested; many-node propagation is designed. The third column is ours: a comparison that lists only the other side's weaknesses is an advertisement, and these four are the ones that would actually sink us.

The centralized cluster

- ✗ Few data centers — physical concentration is the availability root
- ✗ Few corporations — one board's decision reaches every user at once
- ✗ Few jurisdictions — and therefore **few subpoenas required**
- ✗ One credential store; one policy engine; one place to change the rules quietly
- ✗ The operator can read what you send, whether or not it chooses to

The attested constellation

- ✓ Blast radius is one node — compromise proves nothing about any other
- ✓ No central root of availability; nothing to switch off from outside
- ✓ Attested state survives node loss — both sides already hold the receipt
- ✓ An imported approval gets no privileged path; evidence crosses, authority does not
- ✓ Compulsion must reach each owner, individually, in each owner's venue

Our own residual risk

- ◆ **Bootstrap & discovery** — how a new node finds honest peers is unsolved at scale
- ◆ **The first-copy problem** — someone must hold and serve the first verified copy. The distribution answer to it is **designed, activation gated** — not deployed
- ◆ **Per-node operator burden** — upkeep, keys, backups: a real skill floor
- ◆ **No central rescue** — the same property that prevents a kill switch prevents a recovery desk. A lost key is a genuine loss

The honest scoreboard: the constellation trades a *catastrophic single failure* for many *small recoverable ones* plus one *unrecoverable personal one*. That is a better trade for records that must outlive an institution — and a worse one for a user who wants somebody to call.

Why 2026 is the pivot

THE HONEST LINE

Two of these three curves are read from the open record; only the middle one is ours. We claim the harness, not the weather.

1 · OPEN WEIGHTS MADE THIS VIABLE

The open-model community shipped the engines; the constellation is what we add. Open-weight quality crossed the line where a locally runnable model does real, gate-passing production work — not demo work. Our own receipt is one line long: **a 31B open-weight model on a single consumer GPU, at temperature zero, reached blind quality parity with our published catalog on all six dimensions**, and beat it on three — on bounded body production. Book assembly is still the unbuilt tail.

Viability is now a property of the harness, not a property of the budget — and it is a gift from the open lane, not a win over it.

2 · HARNESES STAYED RARE

Everyone has access to weights. Almost nobody has **deterministic gates that bind to no model**, a default-deny manifest, byte-parity reprints, refusals written into the record with the rule cited, and a seal that a script cannot supply. That is the scarce artifact of this cycle — and it is the lane we can show receipts in.

The differentiator moved from the model to the gate.

3 · CAPTURE IS COMPOUNDING

Serving, distribution and regulatory concentration are rising faster than model quality is diverging. Each additional year of concentration makes the exit more expensive and the record harder to move. **The cost of building sovereign is lowest before the dependency is load-bearing** — which is a statement about calendars, not about ideology.

Concentration is a ratchet; it rarely reverses on its own.

The intersection: weights are good enough, harnesses are rare, capture is accelerating. **All three are true at the same time for the first time** — and the third one closes the window on the other two.

Advantage zones

THE HONEST LINE

None of these five is won by having the better model. All five are won by holding the record — which is why the frontier’s lead in the first column of the matrix does not decide them.

Privacy-critical
family & fiduciary

Household finance, estate matters, health records, client files under privilege. The winning property is that the originals never left; the seal names a human; and the record is replayable years later without the vendor.

Offline & contested
no network, no permission

Field, remote, degraded, or simply air-gapped. The bundled roles produce real attested output with no external clone and no account. Rebuild works offline from the bundle alone; a tampered bundle refuses loudly.

Regulated
audit by replay

The auditor does not take your word or your dashboard: they take the export packet and re-derive the state on a clean machine. Same inputs, byte-identical bundle. Refusals survive replay too — a denial is evidence, not an absence.

Generational
the record outlives the vendor

Authority that stays with people is what lets prosperity compound to people. A record of decisions handed intact to the next generation builds wealth that belongs to a family line, not to whoever operates the machine.

Sovereign SMB
the operating manual exists

Receipted obligations are the universal wedge: money owed, work committed, funds restricted, distributions due. The doctrine is not a slide — it is a written book arc standing at the gates, and the ledger engine underneath it runs today.

Proof of doctrine depth — roughly **twenty-one titles in print**: four of five in the foundation series, twelve executive playbooks, five harness volumes, with two further series written and at the gates. The catalog is the operating manual, and the platform follows it rather than racing ahead of it. **Books lead**; runtime is deferred until the paired book seals.

Risks and limitations

THE HONEST LINE

This is not a disclaimer slide. It is the working list. If a competing deck has no slide like this one, that is information about the deck — not about the risk.

LIMITATION	STATUS	WHAT IS ACTUALLY TRUE	MITIGATION — AND WHERE IT STOPS
Per-node intelligence ceiling	OPEN	A node-class model is not a frontier model. Hard novel reasoning is not where a low-power node wins.	Scope the node to bounded work; route the hardest pass to a declared tier where the operator permits it. Gates stay deterministic and bind to no model.
Federation at production scale	DESIGNED · BUILDING	Two-node witness transport is built and tested. Many-node receipted-shard propagation is specified, not deployed.	Designed and deferred to the federation substrate. We do not simulate a mesh, and no slide here shows one.
Seventeen seal-blocking holds	OPEN	The pilot volume is not a book. Seventeen extrusion holds stand against the seal right now.	Every one has a name, a location and a fix path. The seal is refused until they clear — that is the gate working, not failing.
Book-assembly tail unbuilt	OPEN	Body production is proven. Front and back matter, figures, and multi-board review are not built.	Stated in the verdict itself: body-production proven, book-assembly is the unbuilt tail. 8,194 words, under the floor.
Bootstrap / first-copy problem	DESIGNED · BUILDING	A new node must find an honest first copy, and someone must serve it.	Content-addressed release and mirror substrate are designed; activation is gated behind the production line and an explicit human word.
Operator skill floor	OPEN	A node you cannot operate is not sovereign. Keys, backups and upkeep are real burdens.	One-command bootstrap and bundled roles lower the floor; they do not remove it. No central rescue desk exists by design.
The staged layer is not on the trunk	BUILT · STAGED	The policy-and-token layer is green on a build branch, not merged.	Twenty acceptance tests green, spec staged for substrate review before the fold. Counted separately everywhere in this deck.

Recommendations

THE HONEST LINE

No offer is being made on this slide or any other. The ask is a pilot, a read of the code, and counsel before anyone signs anything.

Operators

- ✓ **Run a node.** One command, then activate, then connect — on your own machine, no account, no external clone
- ✓ **Start with the ledger.** Receipted obligations are the wedge every organization already pays for, and the engine runs today
- ✓ **Use the books as manuals.** The catalog is the doctrine; the node is the doctrine executing
- ✓ **Verify before you trust.** Re-verify the whole history cheaply, any time; validate an export packet on a clean machine

Builders

- ◆ **The starter is public.** Reading the code is step zero — not a demo, not a deck
- ◆ **Build against the invariants,** not around them. Human primacy, default-deny, audit-immutable, validated extension
- ◆ **Fork if we fail our own principles.** The licence names that as the intended remedy; what it bars is capture and enclosure
- ◆ **Bring adversarial tests.** A published finding against us is the contribution we most want

Capital & policy

- ◆ **Fund harnesses and attestation, not only weights.** The scarce artifact of this cycle is the gate, and it is under-funded relative to the model
- ◆ **Treat replayability as a compliance primitive.** An auditor who can re-derive state on a clean machine needs less trust, not more paperwork
- ◆ **Measure concentration, not just capability.** Serving, distribution and jurisdiction concentration are the capture surface
- ◆ **Counsel first on anything statute-shaped.** Nothing here is an offer; all economics are modeled, not measured

THE THESIS, IN ONE LINE

Capture requires a center. The constellation doesn't have one — by construction, not by promise.

THE HONEST LINE

Built: the receipted kernel — ledger, human gate, Merkle attestation, guards, witness transport, export packet, bootstrap, the local production line. **Staged:** the policy-and-token layer, green on a branch, not on the trunk. **Designed:** federation at production scale, and uncapturable distribution — activation gated. **The seal:** human, always, and no code path exists that would automate it.

The asymmetry argument only works if the deck making it can be checked. So every capability here carries its grade, every limitation got its own slide, and the two axes where the frontier wins were shown before the six where it does not.

Nothing here claims more than its receipts.

What is in the box — and one answer in advance

MODULE MAP — EVERY ROW HAS A NAMED PASSING TEST FILE

Obligations	ledger · quorum · mandate · witness · cross-node · provenance	RUNS TODAY
Attestation	incremental Merkle accumulator · crypto vector checks · ledger verify CLI	RUNS TODAY
Compliance	human-approval gate (fail-closed, denial recorded)	RUNS TODAY
Evidence	self-verifying export packet · read-only anchored actions projection	RUNS TODAY
Node surface	local HTTP API · owner-only execution · CSRF and rebinding hardening	RUNS TODAY
Production line	build engine · adversary · fixer · editions · review state · human-only seal	RUNS TODAY
Value attribution	value flow · alignment posture · bounded compounding · economic export	RUNS TODAY
Bootstrap	one-command install · bundled demo roles · dependency and lock guards	RUNS TODAY
Policy & token layer	write-rules at open/approve/close · versioned policy loader · token-typed schema — build branch, not the trunk	BUILT · STAGED

Plain files and standard cryptography. No consensus theater — a ledger you can read with your own eyes.
Suite: **442 green on main (+20 staged)**, zero failures, zero skips.

IF SOMEONE GREPS THE SOURCE FOR A LEDGER PROTOCOL'S NAME

They will find a handful of strings in one payout engine's docstrings and one inventory label. The one-sentence answer: **archive-provenance vocabulary in a simulation-only engine, with money_path off one layer up.**

Verified, and stated loudly rather than scrubbed quietly:

- ▶ the module imports only the standard library — no protocol client, no network library
- ▶ no signing path, no submission path, no external network call
- ▶ the payout routine simulates — it prints a transaction log and moves nothing
- ▶ the strings were preserved verbatim under extract-don't-rewrite discipline, with the origin digest recorded

No slide in this deck is built on it, and no external anchoring is claimed anywhere.

THE STANDING FENCES

A token here is a **private, ledgered entry derived from signed receipts** — minted and redeemed under published rules, recomputable on the owner's own node. **Never a coin, never floating, never exchange-tradeable, never speculative.**
money_path is off absolutely: no settle, pay, transfer or disburse method exists on the class. Settlement stays on the operator's own regulated rails. Anything statute-shaped is structured with counsel before anyone signs.